Final decisions

The decisions everything else hangs on — what IronWrap builds first, what it deliberately leaves alone for now, and the gates that decide when each upgrade is actually worth buying.

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Decision summary

IronWrap should stand up a lean internal operating spine before reaching for anything bigger. Today's lead volume doesn't justify buying — or building — the full future stack, so the first deliverable earns its place by solving daily operational control, not by chasing features.

THE FIRST DELIVERABLE HAS TO

- Capture every lead in one place.
- Stop duplicate jobs and folders before they happen.
- Keep the next action visible on every job.
- Keep documents and proposals attached to the right job.
- Make sure deposit and review follow-up never quietly slips.
- Use AI only where it recovers missed opportunities — never where it adds operational risk.

Final stack decision

AREA	FINAL DECISION	REASON
Lead front door	GHL	Already in place, and the best home for lead capture, SMS, booking, nurture, reviews, and the AI pilot.
Website lead capture & attribution	GHL owns it	Home, quote, contact, and service-page forms route into GHL with source URL, page type, service intent, location, and attachment preserved.
Call / source attribution	GHL attribution + number pools first	The first call-source and lead-source attribution path; CallRail is a fallback only if GHL attribution fails real tests.

AREA	FINAL DECISION	REASON
Local lead trust	Google Business Profile, audited in Task 1	CAD $0 to audit and tighten categories, service areas, hours, photos, and the review link — the cheapest local-lead lever.
Paid local ads / LSA	Gated until intake QA passes	Local Services Ads and paid local ads stay off until attribution, first-response tracking, dedupe, and owner exceptions all pass.
Job / customer truth	JobNimbus	Already exists and is built for contractor job workflows.
Accounting truth	QuickBooks	Accounting shouldn't be recreated inside the CRM, AI, or Make.
Automation	Make first	The scenarios and connectors already exist — clean them up before replacing them.
Storage	Google Drive first	Existing subscription; archive only, never job or payment truth.
AI calls	GHL missed-call / after-hours pilot first	Lowest integration friction and lowest new-vendor risk.
Voice fallback	Vapi, then ElevenLabs, then Retell	Only if GHL fails the pilot call tests.
OCR	Structured XML/PDF first, free OCR second, Mistral OCR for hard cases	Don't pay for OCR when the files are already machine-readable.
Field forms & signatures	NaturalForms + JobNimbus	NaturalForms is already subscribed and handles field forms, photos, sketches, signatures, and workflow output; JobNimbus stays job truth.
Proposals	NaturalForms / HTML / PDF flow first	Avoid heavy proposal software until the sales process proves the need.
Dashboard	JobNimbus / GHL reports plus an exceptions view	Build something custom only if the reports fail the owner's workflow.
Shop / ERP	Manual material request first	Paradigm only once the material-request format is stable.
Visualization	Manual photos / products first	Renoworks only if visualizer-led selling becomes a deliberate sales motion.
Security hardening	Last phase, after testing	Owner asked for security and access hardening to follow build, config, and test.

Buy gates

Every paid upgrade stays on hold until a real operational signal clears it.

ITEM	HOLD IF	APPROVE WHEN
GHL AI / Voice AI	Humans can answer and missed-call recovery is enough	Missed calls, after-hours calls, or slow responses are losing real leads.
Local Services Ads / paid local ads	Attribution, first-response tracking, dedupe, or owner exceptions still fail QA	All four pass, and staff can handle the added lead volume.
CallRail or other call tracking	GHL attribution and number pools still pass real call tests	GHL call attribution fails real tests and a measurable source gap remains.
Vapi / ElevenLabs / Retell	GHL voice passes evals	GHL fails booking, transcript, transfer, or call-quality tests.
Renoworks	The visualizer isn't a deliberate sales motion	Website or proposal visualizer demos help close real deals.
RoofRuler volume	Qualified job volume is low	Per-report usage is predictable enough to forecast or negotiate.
NaturalForms REST API / Grow upgrade	The existing JobNimbus integration, webhooks, output settings, and Make cover the first delivery	Native or webhook sync can't meet the acceptance criteria.
Paradigm	The manual material request isn't stable yet	Shop or material errors — or volume — justify the ERP setup cost.
Custom dashboard	Reports plus an exceptions view are enough	The owner still can't see daily blockers without chasing them by hand.

Deliberate non-goals for Task 1

OUT OF SCOPE — ON PURPOSE

- No replacement CRM.
- No replacement accounting.
- No external metal-layout SaaS.
- No automated final pricing without a human in the loop.
- No broad sync of finance data into AI logs, transcripts, or public folders.
- Production ERP waits until the manual materials workflow actually works.
- No NaturalForms REST-API upgrade until the webhook, JobNimbus, and Make paths are tested.
- No free or cheap AI provider touching customer personal information until privacy terms, the vendor register, and a customer notice are all approved.
- No website rebuild before the current forms and source capture are tested.
- No paid local lead campaigns before the intake system proves it can handle more leads.

First deliverable outcome

When it's working, the first deliverable answers eight questions on demand — without anyone reconciling systems by hand:

1. What leads came in?
2. Who owns each one?
3. Which jobs are stuck?
4. Which proposals are waiting?
5. Which deposits or invoices are late?
6. Which materials aren't ready?
7. Which automations failed?
8. Which customer is still waiting on a human?

Business context carried into Task 1

The internal OS has to fit IronWrap's real business mix — not a generic residential-roofing flow. It spans several divisions and the roles that run them.

DIVISIONS TO SUPPORT

- Residential roofing — install and supply.

OPERATING ROLES TO SUPPORT

- Owner / commercial sales.

- Metal siding, soffit, fascia, and gutters.
- Commercial exteriors.
- Shop services and materials supply.
- Raw steel distribution, slitting, and cutting.
- Residential sales rep.
- Receptionist / materials associate.
- Office / admin.
- Field crew / subcontractor.
- Shop / materials.

SALES ASSUMPTIONS (CARRIED FROM V9.1, GATED BY CURRENT LOW VOLUME)

- Average residential job value: **CAD $30,000–$35,000**, with a wider observed range.
- Previous close-rate assumption: **18%**.
- The old 60-reports/month RoofRuler figure is **not** the Task 1 budget basis.
- Lost-lead risk still matters, so missed-call and follow-up discipline stay in scope.

OUT OF THE FIRST DELIVERABLE

- WooCommerce / B2C store.
- Calgary expansion structure.
- Full Paradigm ERP rollout.
- Renoworks purchase or setup — unless visualizer-led selling is approved.